

Water purification

ACTION CHECKLIST

Use safe bottled water when available. For microbial risk, bring clear water to a rolling boil for 1 minute, or 3 minutes above 6,500 feet, and cool before use. Water contaminated with fuel, chemicals or radioactive material cannot be made safe by boiling or ordinary disinfection.

[] Check the source

Avoid floodwater or sources suspected of toxic contamination; find an approved alternative.

[] Clarify cloudy water

Let sediment settle or strain through a clean cloth before treatment; this alone does not disinfect it.

[] Boil for germs

Use the appropriate time and cool safely in a clean container.

[] If boiling is unavailable

Use a treatment product as labeled and official guidance for your water source; filters have different capabilities.

WATCH FOR

Clear water can still contain germs. Ordinary filters may not remove viruses or chemicals.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/guides/water-purification/>

Water purification · official guidance